We managed to get back at the SSB centre on time. Preparation for the personal interview, which was scheduled the next day, was going on in full swing inside our barracks. But Hema and I hit the bed as soon as we entered the barracks. ‘You had asked me a question at the coffee shop,’ I turned to Hema as I lay in bed.

‘Which question?’ She had clearly forgotten.

‘You had asked how it feels to be a privileged child of an army officer,’ I reminded her.

‘And . . . ?’ she said.

‘Well, it feels great,’ I said happily.

I turned to the other side and slept content, leaving a confused Hema with her thoughts.